

continue to use Windows Azure for your service board. Ultimately, you need your data to be stored on the cloud. Apart from this, Microsoft wants the overall audience to understand our platform better, particularly with respect to client technologies.

Q Windows Phone 7 looks like Microsoft's big bet on the mobile platform, particularly in the presence of platforms like iPhone and Android, among others. What is the strategy to promote this platform, and how much is open source going to help you drive Windows Phone 7 further into the market?

Our strategy to drive and promote Windows Phone 7 is to primarily come out with some differentiation. It's all about developers. Windows Phone 7's core engine is based on Silverlight, which is an easy developer platform.

Apart from this, we are closely exploring aspects such as how developers can build rich Internet apps using Eclipse so that they can create apps on this mobile phone platform. In addition, our endeavour is to work with the evolution of HTML5 and JavaScript. These platforms can be expected to leave a big impact on Windows Phone 7.

I think we also need to think in a very creative way, particularly with respect to marketplace requirements. It is very important to look at professional services that help open source organisations make money. We need to think through this problem. And the cloud has to play a critical role—and that too, in a connected environment.

Q Don't you think you should develop an open source business model to offer the tools in the first place?

There are many basic development tools offered for free. Eclipse also follows the same model, which is also called an express edition. These tools are free, and come with basic functionality, which is good for many open source development start-ups. In fact, all the Azure tools from Microsoft are free. All you need is Visual Studio Express and to install Azure. If

you are a .Net developer, everything is free in that model too. In addition, just like other offerings in the ecosystem, the professional model is aimed at big enterprises with large-scale client licensing and support. But when it comes to providing tools for free to developers, we look at it as an investment, to build a developer ecosystem working on Microsoft platforms.

Q How are your global initiatives, such as CodePlex, shaping up?

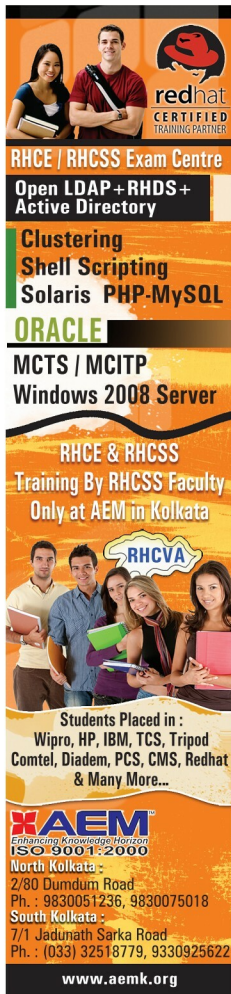
CodePlex is a Microsoft initiative for the developer community. It is another open source organisation. (More details are available at Codeplex.com.)

CodePlex.com has over 10,000 open source extensions and plug-ins for Microsoft server products, 3000 open source extensions or plug-ins for Windows, and thousands of other open source extensions or plug-ins for other Microsoft products such as SQL, SharePoint, Office, and Dynamics CRM. The site also has 160,000 registered users, 10,000 projects, 160 million lines of code published, and 3 million visitors per month.

Q A lot of Microsoft's products are under threat from open source alternatives, and many in the community treat MS as 'Enemy No. 1' :-). What's your message to them?

It is important for me to emphasise that Microsoft does not compete with open source as a category (though there are specific open source products that we do compete against, such as Red Hat Enterprise Linux). Increasingly, open source products complement what we do, as proved by the dramatic growth of open source applications and technologies on Windows.

More than 350,000 open source applications run on Microsoft platforms today (up from 80,000 in 2008/09). This is more than 82 per cent of all open source software found on source forges around the world. And 23 of the top 25 most-downloaded open source projects run on Windows (Source: Geeknet). **END** 



redhat
CERTIFIED
TRAINING PARTNER

RHCE / RHCSS Exam Centre

Open LDAP + RHDS + Active Directory

**Clustering
Shell Scripting
Solaris PHP-MySQL**

ORACLE

**MCTS / MCITP
Windows 2008 Server**

**RHCE & RHCSS
Training By RHCSS Faculty
Only at AEM in Kolkata**

RHCVA

Students Placed in :
Wipro, HP, IBM, TCS, Tripod
Comtel, Diadem, PCS, CMS, Redhat
& Many More...

AEM
Enhancing Knowledge Horizon
ISO 9001:2000

North Kolkata :
2/80 Dum Dum Road
Ph. : 9830051236, 9830075018

South Kolkata :
7/1 Jadunath Sarka Road
Ph. : (033) 32518779, 9330925622

www.aemk.org